THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE · Nursery – Class XII · Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur · 9887258679

CLASS VIII — SOCIAL SCIENCE · PRACTICE QUESTION PAPER

Annual / Full-Syllabus Examination (Part 1 + Part 2) · Session 2026–27 · Set 05

Class: 8	Subject: Social Science	Set 05	Time Allowed: 2 Hours 30 Minutes	Max. Marks: 60

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper is divided into six sections – A, B, C, D, E and F.
3. Section A contains Question No. 1 with 15 sub-parts, all Multiple Choice Questions. Each sub-part carries 1 mark. Choose the correct option.
4. Section B contains Question Nos. 2 to 5, which are very short answer questions carrying 2 marks each. Answer each question in at least 20 words.
5. Section C contains Question Nos. 6 and 7, which are short answer questions carrying 3 marks each. Answer each question in about 40–60 words.
6. Section D contains Question Nos. 8 and 9, which are long answer questions carrying 5 marks each. Answer each question in about 80–100 words.
7. Section E contains Question Nos. 10 to 13, which are source/case-based questions carrying 4 marks each (1+1+2). Read the given source carefully and answer the questions that follow.
8. Section F contains Question No. 14, a map-based question carrying 5 marks. Mark the given locations on the map using appropriate symbols/signs.
9. No overall choice has been provided in the question paper; however, internal choices are given in some questions. Attempt only one option in such questions.
10. For Visually Impaired students, a separate question has been provided in place of Question No. 14. It is to be attempted only by Visually Impaired students.
11. Maintain neatness and clarity while writing answers.

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1×15=15) — 15 marks

Question 1 · Choose the correct option for each sub-part.

1.(i) The Spinifex people have lived in the Great Australian Desert for more than — **(1)**

(A) 250 years (B) 2,500 years (C) 2 lakh years (D) 25,000 years

(ii) In India, the Prime Minister is appointed by the — **(1)**

(A) Chief Justice of India (B) President
(C) Speaker of the Lok Sabha (D) Election Commission

(iii) At the start of the Quit India Movement in 1942, the Congress flag at Gowalia Tank Maidan, Mumbai, was hoisted by — **(1)**

(A) Sarojini Naidu (B) Aruna Asaf Ali (C) Kanaklata Barua (D) Annie Besant

(iv) The Mehrangarh Fort, built of local red sandstone, overlooks the city of — **(1)**

(A) Jaipur (B) Bikaner (C) Udaipur (D) Jodhpur

(v) A High Court judge retires at the age of — **(1)**

(A) 62 years (B) 58 years (C) 65 years (D) 70 years

(vi) Read Statement I and Statement II and select the correct option. **(1)**

Statement I: Fundamental Rights such as freedom of speech are subject to reasonable restrictions.

Statement II: The right to freedom of religion allows a person to force others to follow his or her religion.

(A) Only I is correct (B) Only II is correct
(C) Both are correct (D) Both are incorrect

(vii) A population pyramid with a narrow base and a bulging middle indicates that — **(1)**

(A) there are many children and very few adults
(B) everyone is elderly
(C) birth rates are falling and the working-age group is large
(D) the population is falling rapidly

(viii) Which NCR city became a major hub for Business Process Outsourcing (BPO)? **(1)**

(A) Meerut (B) Rohtak (C) Alwar (D) Gurugram

(ix) Given below are two statements – Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read them and select the correct option. **(1)**

Assertion (A): Over-fishing threatens the survival of many fish species.
Reason (R): Fish are harvested faster than they can regenerate.

(A) A is correct, R is incorrect
(B) A is incorrect, R is correct
(C) Both A and R are correct and R is the correct explanation of A
(D) Both A and R are correct but R is not the correct explanation of A

(x) The Ahom kingdom, ruled for about six centuries, was located in the — **(1)**

(A) Ganga valley (B) Konkan coast
(C) Brahmaputra valley (Assam) (D) Deccan plateau

(xi) The Peshwas of the Maratha state were — **(1)**

(A) Mughal governors (B) hereditary prime ministers
(C) tax collectors (D) temple priests only

(xii) After the Revolt of 1857, the rule of India passed from the East India Company to — **(1)**

(A) the British Crown (B) the Mughal emperor
(C) the Marathas (D) the Indian National Congress

(xiii) The NOTA option on an EVM allows a voter to — **(1)**

(A) reject all the candidates if he or she does not like any
(B) vote twice
(C) change the symbol
(D) cast a vote by post

(xiv) Soil, water, forests and minerals belong to which factor of production? **(1)**

(A) Labour (B) Land
(C) Capital (D) Entrepreneurship

(xv) Given below are two statements – Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read them and select the correct option. **(1)**

Assertion (A): Words like 'kitāb' and 'dukān' are found in many Indian languages today.
Reason (R): Persian was the language of administration and the court for centuries, so its words entered regional languages.

(A) A is correct, R is incorrect
(B) A is incorrect, R is correct
(C) Both A and R are correct and R is the correct explanation of A
(D) Both A and R are correct but R is not the correct explanation of A

SECTION B — Very Short Answer Questions (4×2=8) — 8 marks

Question Nos. 2 to 5 · each carries 2 marks · at least 20 words.

2.(A) Who was Tarabai? Why is she remembered in Maratha history? **(2)**

O R

2.(B) Who was Lachit Borphukan and what was his victory? **(2)**

3. Distinguish between a citizen and a resident of a country. **(2)**

4.(A) What was the Lucknow Pact of 1916? **(2)**

OR

4.(B) What was the Rowlatt Act and why was it opposed? **(2)**

5. Explain the difference between the head of state and the head of government in India. **(2)**

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (2×3=6) — 6 marks

Question Nos. 6 and 7 · each carries 3 marks · about 40–60 words.

6.(A) Explain any three problems created by an ageing population. **(3)**

OR

6.(B) Suggest any three ways in which cities can become more sustainable. **(3)**

7.(A) State any three ways in which British land-revenue policies harmed Indian peasants. **(3)**

OR

7.(B) State any three advantages of using EVMs in elections. **(3)**

SECTION D — Long Answer Questions (2×5=10) — 10 marks

Question Nos. 8 and 9 · each carries 5 marks · about 80–100 words.

8.(A) Describe the Swadeshi Movement and the Partition of Bengal (1905) under the following points: causes, methods, leaders and results. **(5)**

OR

8.(B) Explain how oceans influence climate and trade with examples such as the Gulf Stream, the Suez Canal and the Persian Gulf. **(5)**

9. Describe the rise of Maratha power under Shivaji up to his coronation in 1674. **(5)**

SECTION E — Case / Source Based Questions (4×4=16) — 16 marks

Question Nos. 10 to 13 · each carries 4 marks (1+1+2).

10. **Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)**

> On the evening of 8 August 1942, Gandhi addressed a huge crowd at Gowalia Tank Maidan in Bombay. He told them to act on a simple mantra — 'Do or Die'. Within hours of the Quit India resolution, the top Congress leaders, including Gandhi, were arrested. Without leaders, ordinary people took over the movement: there were strikes, protests and attacks on government offices. Though crushed by force, the movement showed that the demand for freedom could no longer be ignored.

Questions:

(10.1) What was Gandhi's mantra during the Quit India Movement? (1)

(10.2) What happened to the top Congress leaders soon after the resolution? (1)

(10.3) State two reasons why Quit India is considered a turning point. (2)

11. **Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)**

> The river Kaveri flows through Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala and Puducherry. Its water is used for farming, drinking and generating power in all these places. In years of poor rainfall, the states often disagree about how much water each should receive. Such rivers can only be managed through cooperation among the states that share them.

Questions:

(11.1) Name two of the states or Union Territories through which the Kaveri flows. (1)

(11.2) Why do disputes about river water arise in years of low rainfall? (1)

(11.3) Suggest two ways of resolving such disputes. (2)

12. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> In the 1970s the white marble of the Taj Mahal began to turn yellowish. Experts traced the problem to pollution from industries around Agra, which burned coal and other fossil fuels. Following a public interest petition and the work of an expert committee, polluting industries near the monument were controlled in the mid-1990s. Protecting such heritage is also the Fundamental Duty of every citizen.

Questions:

(12.1) What was happening to the Taj Mahal's marble in the 1970s? (1)

(12.2) What was the main cause of this damage? (1)

(12.3) State one legal step and one thing citizens can do to protect heritage monuments. (2)

13. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> India's child mortality — the number of children who die before the age of five for every 1,000 born — was 271 in 1950. By 2023 it had fallen to 28. Better health care, vaccination, clean drinking water and education of mothers all helped. As more children survived, India's population grew rapidly for several decades before birth rates also began to fall.

Questions:

(13.1) By how much per 1,000 did child mortality fall between 1950 and 2023? (1)

(13.2) State one reason for this fall. (1)

(13.3) How did the fall in child mortality affect India's population growth in the following decades? Explain in two points. (2)

SECTION F — Map Based Question (1×5=5) — 5 marks

Question No. 14 · 5 marks.

14. On the Political outline Map of India provided, locate and label any **five** of the following places using appropriate symbols/signs: (5×1=5) **(5)**

(I) Dandi
(II) Nalanda
(III) Bhubaneswar (Khorda region)
(IV) Sambalpur
(V) Lucknow
(VI) Hyderabad

The following questions are for Visually Impaired students only, in lieu of Question No. 14. Answer any five questions:

(I) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Dandi located? 1
(II) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Nalanda located? 1
(III) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Bhubaneswar located? 1
(IV) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Sambalpur located? 1
(V) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Lucknow located? 1
(VI) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Hyderabad located? 1

